Manoj Sharma

Staff Quality Engineer | QE Tech Lead | Engineering Manager | Stuttgart, Germany | manojsharma.tesla@gmail.com | LinkedIn Profile

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Professional Summary

Strategic Staff Quality Engineer with over 15 years of experience leading high-performing QA organizations and architecting scalable automation ecosystems. Expertise in Java, Python, and TypeScript with a pioneering focus on AI-augmented testing, Performance Engineering, and Shift-Left methodologies. Proven leader in building custom internal productivity tools (AI & Performance) and mentoring engineers to adopt a "Quality-as-Code" mindset across global enterprises.

Technical Skills

- **AI & Innovation**: Cursor (AI-native prototyping), LLM-based Automation Skills, AI-driven Code Review tools, Automated Test Plan Generation (JIRA/PRD analysis).
- **Core Languages**: Java, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Perl.
- **Automation Frameworks**: Playwright, Cypress, Selenium WebDriver, TestNG, JUnit 5, pytest, Rest Assured.
- **Specializations**: UI/API Automation, Performance Testing (Locust), Microservices Architecture, SaaS Platforms, ITIL.
- **DevOps & Infrastructure**: Jenkins (CI/CD Pipeline Architect), Docker, GitHub/Git, Perforce, Linux (Server-side expertise).
- **Leadership**: Engineering Management, Professional Development Plans (PDP), Recruitment Strategy (Technical Assessment Design), Strategic Test Planning, Test Coaching.

Professional Experience

Celonis | *Germany* | Jun 2022 – Present

- **Position:** Staff Quality Engineer / Lead QA
- **Responsibilities and Achievements:**
    - **AI Strategy & Implementation**: Leveraged Cursor for rapid prototyping and experimenting with next-gen automation ideas; developed custom AI Skills to automate Code Reviews and generate Test Plans directly from JIRA tickets and PRDs.
    - **Architected UI Performance Tooling**: Built a custom E2E UI Performance tool based on Playwright, enabling teams to measure frontend latency and detect regressions within the CI/CD cycle.
    - **Performance Engineering**: Spearheaded performance testing initiatives using Locust (Python), collaborating with developers to benchmark system stability and optimize microservices.
    - **Internal Tooling**: Developed and integrated Python-based tools with GitHub to provide automated, actionable summary views of automation results for cross-functional stakeholders.
    - **Engineering Management**: Directly manage the QE team, overseeing Professional Development Plans and individual growth trajectories; act as the technical authority for UI and API automation frameworks.
    - **Cross-Functional Leadership**: Partner with Dev Tech Leads to influence product engineering design; represent the QE organization in quarterly executive status presentations.
    - **Engineering Leadership:** Directly manage the QE team, overseeing Professional Development Plans and scaling the org through technical recruitment.

MERCEDES-BENZ.IO | *Germany* | Dec 2019 – Apr 2022

- **Position:** Test Manager / QA Lead
- **Responsibilities and Achievements:**
    - **Project Leadership**: Led a high-impact QA team, overseeing the end-to-end development of multiple automation frameworks for UI and API testing using Cypress and Selenium.
    - **Test Coaching for Developers**: Institutionalized "Test Coaching," conducting knowledge-sharing sessions that empowered developers to contribute to the API Automation framework and own their quality gates.
    - **Optimized Quality Standards**: Defined and integrated automation into the Definition of Done (DoD), ensuring robust test coverage with zero

redundancy.
    - **Chapter Influence**: Collaborated across the global QA Chapter to mentor team members and drive organization-wide process improvements.
    - **Technical Recruitment**: Owned the technical assessment pipeline, designing QA challenges and conducting interviews for internal and external hires.

WAYFAIR GMBH | *Germany* | Nov 2018 – 2019

- **Position:** Senior QE Engineer
- **Responsibilities and Achievements:**
    - **Process Architecture**: Specified and designed scalable QA processes and new UI/API automation frameworks from scratch.
    - **Training & Onboarding**: Authored technical documentation and led training sessions for new joiners on automation best practices

BMC SOFTWARE | *India* | Dec 2011 – Oct 2018

- **Position:** Senior QE Engineer
- **Responsibilities and Achievements:**
    - **Automation Team Leadership:** Spearheaded the Automation team, managing day-to-day operations and coordinating testing efforts for a 15+ member QA organization.
    - **Framework Design & Architecture:** Collaborated directly with the QA Architect to design and implement a next-generation automation framework tailored for Microservices and Next-Gen SaaS platforms (ITIL domain).
    - **CI/CD Modernization:** Engineered and maintained a robust CI/CD pipeline using **Jenkins and GitHub**, optimizing the delivery lifecycle for automation suites.
    - **Technical Mentorship:** Provided technical support and mentorship to junior QAs; performed rigorous Automation Code Reviews to ensure high standards of maintainability and quality.
    - **Coverage Optimization:** Defined and tracked key performance indicators, including Automation Code Coverage and Use Case Coverage, to ensure comprehensive risk mitigation.
    - **Legacy Migration:** Successfully led the migration of the monolith automation codebase from Perforce to GitHub, re-structuring the architecture for modern DevOps compatibility.

PERSISTENT SYSTEMS | *India* | Sep 2008 – Dec 2011

- **Position:** Senior Software Engineer

- **Responsibilities and Achievements:**
    - **Platform & Server QA**: Conducted deep-dive server-side testing on Linux environments for Telecom and Messaging domains.
    - **Foundation Automation**: Developed automated test suites using Perl scripting and QTP (QuickTest Professional).
    - **Deployment Architecture**: Established a Deployment Lab at a US client location to validate complex architecture; trained customers on product deployment and server configuration.

Education

- B.E. (Honors) in Electronics and Communication Engineering
  University of Rajasthan (2004–2008)

Training/Certifications

Available on LinkedIn